

From Learning to Leading: The Role of Emerging Technologies in IT Education

Going into a talk focused on IT education, although it is my field of study, I still find it a dry and boring lecture if it is not hands-on. However, the guest speaker added humor while presenting, which made us laugh and listen to him. His goal was to show us how to transform from technical students to future industry leaders. He did achieve it, this seminar taught me a lot on how to shape the future me to suit better within our industry.

Mr. Pilar pointed out that while traditional schoolwork gives us the foundational skills, it is still up to us, our own curiosity, to pick up emerging skills. I really relate to what he said because after school, I would only know what I learned from school and nothing beyond it. This made me realize that I should be more curious and go farther than what school has taught me, as there is more to learn, and our industry is fast-paced. True tech leadership requires mastering critical soft skills like empathy, creativity, cognitive flexibility, and resilience. That's what I have taken notes on from the session. These human-centric traits are what truly matter because they are things that an AI simply cannot replicate. What I truly appreciated is how Mr. Pilar didn't intimidate us with how competitive the nature of our industry is, but instead he guided us and eased some of our anxieties on academics and shared some of his relatable experiences. He kindly gave us wisdom to show us how achievable leadership actually is.

An unforgettable takeaway from his seminar was that AI should not be looked at as a threat to our future careers, but instead we should view it as a powerful tool that can help us achieve our goals more efficiently. This seminar taught me that education does not stop at the classroom doors, and it is truly up to us on how we transform ourselves into tech leaders, our willingness to learn, to stay curious, and to embrace emerging technologies with the right mindset and being adaptive.